Cuba they themselves began crying a lot about Berlin," argued Mikoyan. "Both sides were talking about the Berlin crisis, but simultaneously believed that at that given moment the essence of their policy was located in Cuba."[8]

Mikoyan was not making things up. The Soviets did indeed fall into the very same trap they had set for Kennedy: if he believed they were serious about Berlin, they believed that he was simply playing them. "Both we and the Americans talked about Berlin—both sides with the same aim, namely, to draw attention away from Cuba; the Americans, in order to attack it; we, in order to make the USA uneasy and postpone attacking Cuba," Khrushchev told a visiting Czechoslovak delegation on October 30.[9]

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KHRUSHCHEV WAS USING THE BERLIN ISSUE TO BUY MORE time to deliver his missiles and nuclear warheads to Cuba, but he was also eager to use the time available to prepare for a possible American invasion of Cuba, which now looked more likely than ever. Instead of backing off, he intensified the pace of missile delivery and added new types of nuclear weapons to the list.

On the day Khrushchev met Udall at Pitsunda, Marshal Malinovsky in Moscow prepared a top-secret document handwritten by one of his top officers. Malinovsky proposed to strengthen the Cuba task force with ten to twelve IL-28 bombers capable of carrying nuclear weapons. They were to be accompanied by six atomic bombs, each with the explosive power of 8 to 12 kilotons, more than one-half of the TNT yield of the Hiroshima bomb. Such bombs were considered tactical and designed to be used in combat. That was not all. Malinovsky proposed to send eighteen "Zemlia" (Earth) cruise missiles armed with nuclear warheads and two to three divisions of "Luna" (Moon, in NATO reporting FROG) tactical missiles. That would amount to either eight or twelve Luna rockets, armed with nuclear warheads. The strategic nuclear forces were now to be reinforced with tactical ones capable of protecting the "big guys" in case of attack and ground invasion.